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Ques-2 - Discuss how the Govt. of India Acts of 1858 and 1861 reflect the British response to the Revolt of 1857 - not just as a political crisis, but as an administrative reckoning.

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Answer:- The government of India Acts of 1858 and 1861 were deeply rooted in the revolt of 1857 which sparked due to ill administrative policies of the East India Company. These acts brought major changes in the administrative system of India by abolishing EIC.

Govt. of India Act, 1858

- Queen Victoria's Proclamation
- Abolition of EIC
- Post of 'Secretary of State' for India was created.

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Govt. of India Act, 1861

- Expansion of Governor General legislative Council.
- Incorporation of non-official members.
- Portfolio system started.

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Both Acts as the British response to the revolt of 1857

Due to the mass uprising in 1857, ^{British} Government realised the need of structural changes in the administration of India.

① Queen Victoria's Proclamation
(1 November, 1858)

② Transfer of Power

EIC was abolished and the governance of India directly came under the British Crown.

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- (b) • Non-interference in affairs of princely states.
→ Doctrine of Lapse was abolished.

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② Laid the foundation of Indian representation in governance system.

(a) Through inclusion of Indians in Legislative Council.

eg:- Raja of Benaras, Maharaja of Patiala, Sir Dinkar Rao.

(b) Inclusion of non-official members.

③ Provinces like Bombay, Madras were given autonomy to make laws.

④ ~~It~~ start of decentralisation process in administration.

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④ Portfolio system started.

↳ Laid the foundation of cabinet government in India.

↳ It ensures government to be more accountable and responsible.

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Thus, the government of India acts of 1858 and 1861 were introduced to address grievances of Indians effectively in order to prevent future political crisis. Administrative system was made inclusive and representative with the participation of Indians and provincial autonomy.

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